

Students will analyze a primary source to make a claim about working conditions in early factories and support it with evidence.

Wednesday, September 16, 2026 · 7:40 PM

World History

10th

The Industrial Revolution

1

Your Plan

As you submitted it.

8th period (last period of the day), 50 minutes.

Do Now (5 min): Photo of a textile mill interior on the board. Write one thing you notice and one question you have.

Mini-lesson (10 min): Quick review of the factory system and why it replaced cottage industry. Key vocabulary: factory system, textile mill, child labor.

Primary source (8 min): Excerpt of a factory worker's testimony to Parliament (Sadler Committee, 1832). I read the first paragraph aloud, then they read the rest silently.

Half-sheet (12 min): Thirty seconds on your own first — write down one thing that stands out to you. Then with your partner, agree on ONE claim about working conditions and ONE piece of evidence from the testimony. Both names on the half-sheet.

Share out (10 min): I call on pairs, not individuals — "What did your pair put down?" I push for evidence: which line in the testimony backs that up?

Exit ticket (5 min): Write down one thing you heard from another pair that changed your mind.

Note to self: this class is silent. The same three students answer everything and everyone else waits

them out. Last time I tried think-pair-share the pairs just chatted about their weekend. The half-sheet is supposed to give pairs something they have to produce before anyone talks.

2

Coaching

What's working, and where it will wobble.

This is a single-day, 50-minute lesson, and the bones of it are genuinely solid — you can see the objective (analyze a primary source, make a claim, support it with evidence) running through nearly every step rather than sitting off to the side as decoration.

The structure builds logically: the Do Now activates noticing/questioning, the mini-lesson gives just enough vocabulary and context to make the source legible, and then the half-sheet asks students to do the actual thinking the objective demands — claim plus evidence, in writing, before anyone has to speak. That sequencing is smart, and it's clearly a direct response to what you know about this class period. Naming that the silent thirty-seconds-alone step exists specifically to give reluctant talkers something concrete to lean on before the pair work — that's exactly the kind of diagnosis-and-fix thinking that makes a lesson plan trustworthy. You're not just running a script; you're solving a real problem with this specific group.

A few things to look at:

The gradual release here is more "I do a little, then straight to you do" than a true I do / we do / you do. The mini-lesson gives content but not a model of the actual skill — making a claim and backing it with a specific line of text. Given how silent and evidence-shy this class is, it might help to do one moment of "we do" between the mini-lesson and the half-sheet: read one sentence of the testimony together and think aloud, "this line makes me think X, because it says Y" — modeling the exact move you want on the half-sheet. Thirty seconds is enough; you don't need to eat much time, but showing the move once before asking pairs to produce it cold could raise the quality of what comes back.

The higher-order thinking is there in the task (claim + evidence) but the primary source itself is thin — one excerpt, 8 minutes, partly read aloud by you. With Sadler Committee testimony, there's often room for a slightly meatier or slightly more haunting excerpt that gives pairs more to disagree about, which would also help the share-out generate real friction instead of everyone converging on the same obvious claim.

Closure is real, but the exit ticket is asking students to report on someone else's thinking ("what changed your mind") rather than to state their own claim one more time in their own words. That's a nice listening-accountability move, but it means you don't get a final individual check on whether each student, alone, can now do the actual objective — claim plus evidence. You might alternate: some days

"what changed your mind," other days "state your own claim and evidence now, in your own words," so you're getting individual formative data on the skill itself, not just on engagement.

Pacing looks realistic for 50 minutes, and structuring the share-out around pairs rather than individuals is a good workaround for the participation pattern you're seeing — it lowers the risk of being wrong alone. Worth naming to yourself as a strategy that's working, not just a workaround.